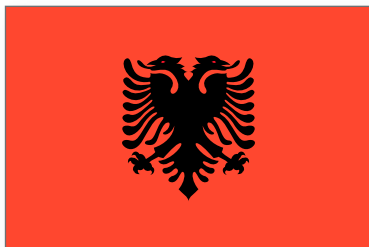


Albania

Ratio: 5:7 **Adopted:** April 7, 1992 **Usage:** National

Albanians call their country *Shqipëria*, meaning “land of the eagle”



The traditional heraldic Albanian flag first used in 1912 when independence was restored

Europe



Once part of the Byzantine Empire, **Albania** became a kingdom in 1912. From 1944 to 1991 it was a strict communist state.

The black eagle first appeared on the Albanian flag in the 15th century when Albania became part of the Byzantine Empire. According to legend, the Albanians are the descendants of the eagle. The red flag, with the eagle in the center, was adopted in 1912, when independence was restored. Parts of the Italian arms

were included on the flag after the invasion of 1939, but the original flag was restored in 1942.

In 1946, the flag changed again, to incorporate a gold-edged red star above the eagle, representing the communist regime. The star was removed in 1991, by order of the new multiparty government.

ARMS OF ALBANIA

The black eagle has been an emblem of Albania since the 15th century



The two-headed eagle first appeared on flags used during the struggle against Turkish occupation